

C46 · STORY

The First Chapter

The Past, the Present, and the Story of Us

The First Chapter

Write the beginning twice, apart, before either voice can steer it.

1. 10 quiet minutes. Five lines each: where it begins for you, and a different day is allowed; what you were unsure of; one detail later tellings have polished; what you guessed the other person felt; one fact you still do not know, which may stay private.
2. One person reads the five lines. The listener does not correct a name or improve a line. Private marks only: same memory, news to me, I remember it differently. Then switch.
3. Now talk. Say both beginnings and what each is counting. One curious question for the news. Set disagreements side by side, and do not average them.

Optional: one agreed fact and one uncertainty you will leave in. Or name that uncertainty and stop.

Stop if a live argument about faithfulness is waiting. Have it in plain time.

Skip any stretch you do not want replayed. No reason is required. You may stop after one scene.